JOB TRACKER · VISUAL DIRECTION

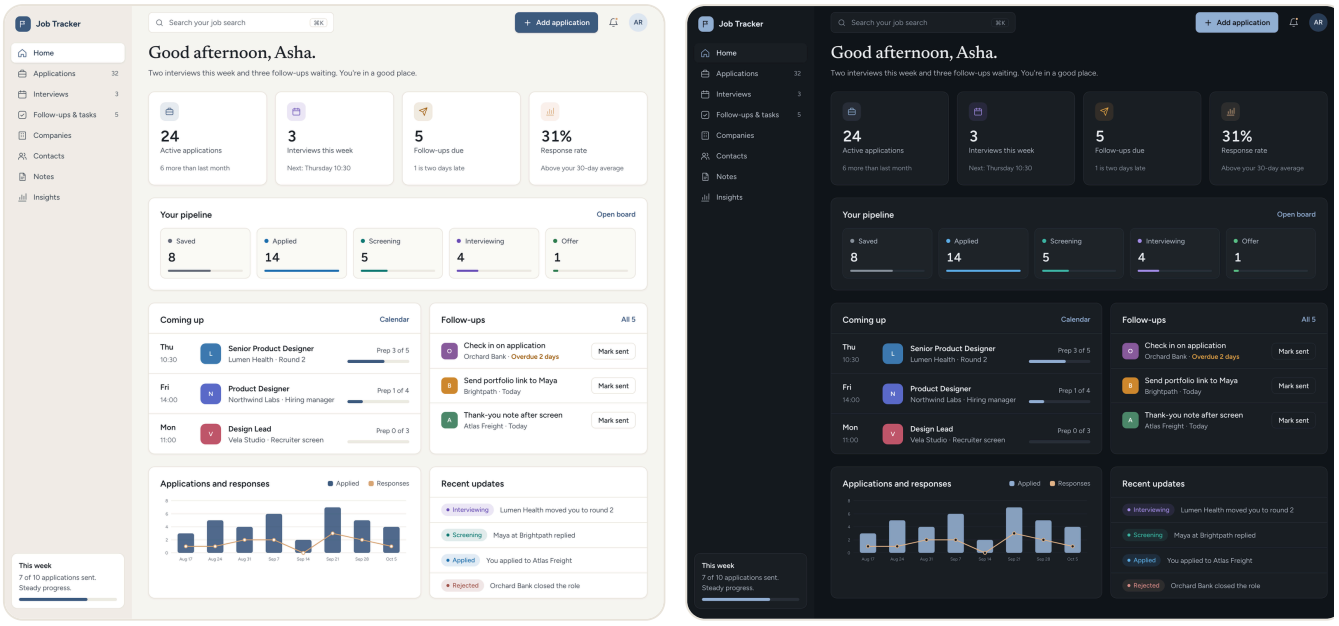
Harbor Slate

Harbor's warm, calm layout with a muted slate blue for trust and a sand accent for hope. This is the direction exploration, not yet the final design system.

10 October 2026 · SB Dev

Why Harbor Slate

Slate blue wins because it carries blue's trust without looking like LinkedIn or Indeed, and its low intensity suits an anxious user.



Home dashboard in light and dark mode. Company names, people and numbers are invented sample data; "Job Tracker" is a placeholder wordmark.

How brands use colour

Colour psychology is real but context-dependent. Strong brands choose a colour for three reasons: the feeling it creates, how it separates them from competitors, and years of consistent use. Harbor Slate is chosen on the same three tests.

Test	What the job seeker needs	How Harbor Slate answers it
Feeling	Calm and control during an anxious, uncertain search	Blue is the colour most associated with trust and stability; a muted slate lowers emotional intensity further

Test	What the job seeker needs	How Harbor Slate answers it
Standing out	A tool that does not blur into LinkedIn, Indeed or Naukri, which use bright saturated blues	Slate is greyer and softer than any of them; with the ivory canvas and serif greeting it reads as its own brand
Hope	Encouragement without false cheer	Sand, a warm accent, appears only at small moments (chart response line, milestones, offer celebration)
Meaningful status colours	Green must feel special for an offer; red only for errors	A blue brand leaves green, amber, red and violet free for the pipeline
Daily use for months	Low eye strain, comfortable dark mode	Muted colours tire the eyes less; slate's dark mode is the most comfortable of the options tested
Broad audience	Works for graduates and senior leaders, any gender	Slate is age- and gender-neutral and reads as professional across cultures, including India

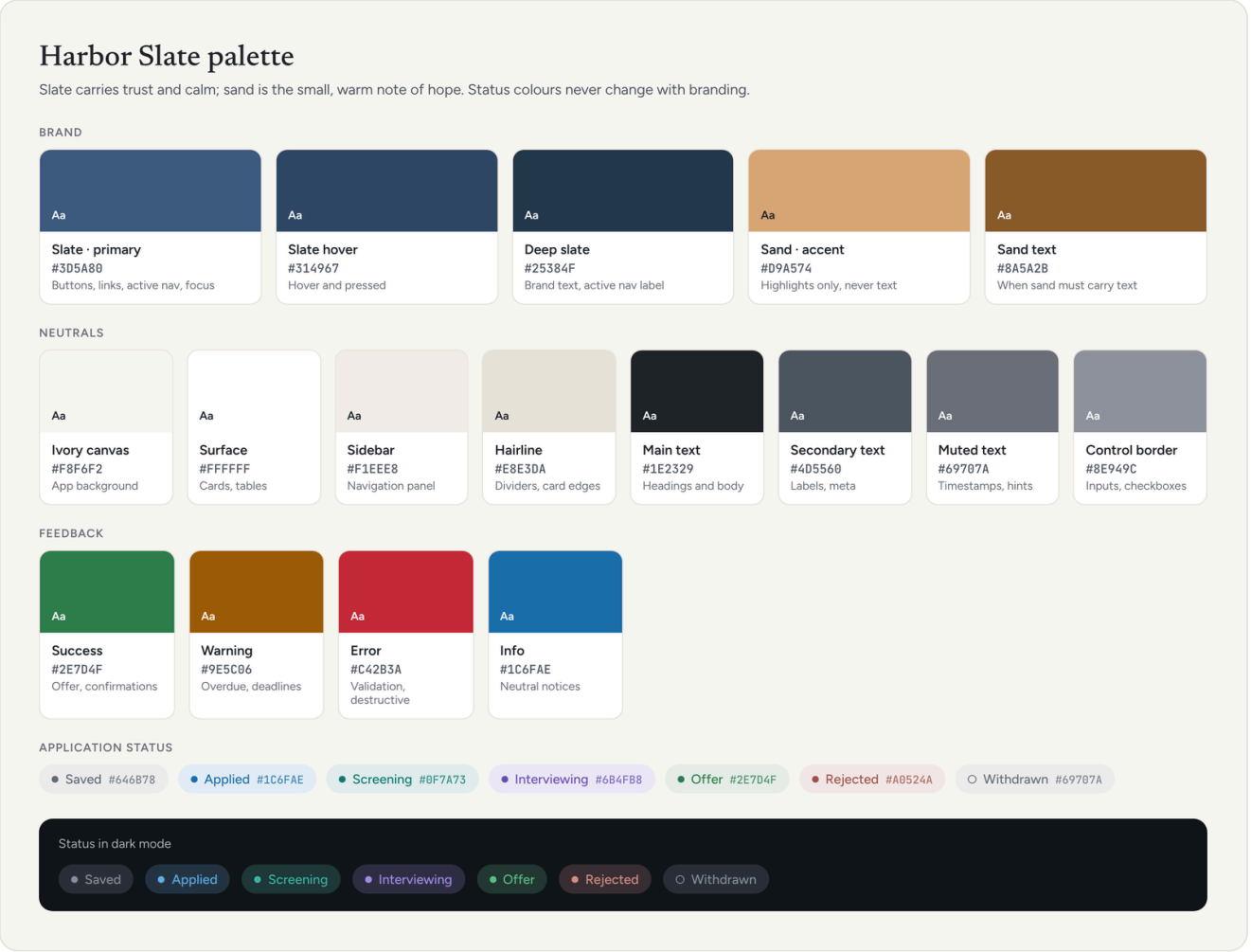
What changed from the original Harbor

- Primary colour: deep teal → slate blue #3D5A80.
- Accent: terracotta → sand #D9A574.
- Text neutrals re-tuned from green-grey to slate-grey so they sit with the new primary.
- **Applied** status moved to a bright cerulean #1C6FAE so it stays distinct from the muted slate brand.
- Primary buttons get a subtle shadow and inner bottom edge, so a muted colour still reads as clickable.

Layout, typography, ivory canvas, shapes and components are unchanged from Harbor.

Colour palette

Slate does the work, the ivory canvas does the warming, and sand is a spice used once or twice per screen.



Role	Light	Dark	Use
Primary	`#3D5A80`	`#93AFD3`	Primary buttons, links, active nav icon, focus ring, chart series 1
Primary hover	`#314967`	`#A9C1E0`	Hover and pressed on primary
Secondary	`#25384F`	`#E0E7F0`	Brand wordmark, active nav label, inverse chips
Accent (sand)	`#D9A574`	`#E2B48A`	Decorative only: chart highlight, milestones, offer celebration, notification dot
Accent text	`#8A5A2B`	`#E2B48A`	When a sand-coloured label is unavoidable (5.4:1 on ivory)
Background	`#F8F6F2`	`#121519`	App canvas
Sidebar	`#F1EEE8`	`#15191E`	Navigation panel
Surface	`#FFFFFF`	`#1A1F25`	Cards, tables, panels
Elevated surface	`#FFFEFC` + shadow	`#222830`	Menus, popovers, modals
Main text	`#1E2329`	`#ECEFF2`	Headings, body

Role	Light	Dark	Use
Secondary text	`#4D5560`	`#AEB6C0`	Labels, meta, column headers
Muted text	`#69707A`	`#87909B`	Timestamps, placeholders, helper text
Border (hairline)	`#E8E3DA`	`#2A3038`	Dividers, card edges
Control border	`#8E949C`	`#68727E`	Inputs, selects, checkboxes (3:1 or better)
Success	`#2E7D4F`	`#5CC287`	Offer, confirmations
Warning	`#9E5C06`	`#E9A84A`	Overdue follow-ups, deadlines within 48 hours
Error	`#C42B3A`	`#F27180`	Validation, destructive actions
Info	`#1C6FAE`	`#5FB0EA`	Neutral system notices, tips

Application status colours

Status colours are fixed semantics and never change with branding. Every badge shows colour plus a text label.

Stage	Light	Dark	Notes
Saved	`#646B78`	`#8A929C`	Neutral, not acted on yet
Applied	`#1C6FAE`	`#5FB0EA`	Bright cerulean, deliberately more saturated than the slate brand
Screening	`#0F7A73`	`#3FB8A6`	First contact made
Interviewing	`#6B4FB8`	`#A68EEA`	Active process
Offer	`#2E7D4F`	`#5CC287`	The one moment green should feel earned
Rejected	`#A0524A`	`#D99088`	Dusty, not alarming; rejections are frequent
Withdrawn	`#69707A`, hollow dot	`#87909B`, hollow dot	Closed, inactive

Usage rules

- Slate is the only strong colour on a screen; one primary button per view.
- Sand never carries text or meaning alone, and never appears in large areas.
- Red is reserved for errors and destructive actions, never for low numbers or slow weeks.
- Large areas stay neutral (ivory, white, sidebar); colour lives in small, meaningful places.

Typography

Figtree runs the whole interface; Newsreader, a serif, appears only in a few human moments.

- **UI and body:** Figtree 400 / 500 / 600 (700 only for the wordmark). Friendly rounded shapes, very legible at 14–15px, free on Google Fonts, with tabular figures for counts, dates and salaries.
- **Display (limited):** Newsreader 500 for the dashboard greeting, empty-state headlines, onboarding and milestone moments. Never in tables, forms or navigation.

- **Why:** the serif gives the brand a recognizable, human voice at almost no cost; keeping it out of data UI keeps screens efficient.

Style	Font	Size / line height	Weight	Use
Display	Newsreader	32 / 40	500	Greeting, onboarding, milestones
H1	Figtree	24 / 32	600	Page titles
H2	Figtree	20 / 28	600	Section titles
H3	Figtree	16–17 / 24	600	Card titles
Body	Figtree	15 / 24	400	Default reading text
Body compact	Figtree	14 / 20	400–500	Tables, dense lists
Small	Figtree	13 / 18	400–500	Meta, helper text
Caption	Figtree	12 / 16	500	Badges, chart labels

Headings use tight tracking (-0.01em); numbers in KPIs and tables use tabular figures so columns align.

Visual characteristics

Soft, paper-like cards on a warm desk: rounded, lightly shadowed, never heavy.

Element	Specification
Radius	8px controls, 12px cards, 16px modals, pill for badges and avatars
Borders	1px warm hairline `#E8E3DA` for structure; 1px control border `#8E949C` for inputs and checkboxes
Shadows	Card: 0 1px 3px rgba(60,45,30,0.06). Overlay: 0 12px 32px rgba(60,45,30,0.12). Dark mode uses lighter surfaces instead of shadows
Cards	White on ivory, 12px radius, 24px padding, subtle shadow, title row with optional link at right
Primary button	40px tall, 8px radius, slate fill, white text (7.1:1), 600 weight, shadow 0 1px 2px rgba(37,56,79,0.22) plus a 1px darker inner bottom edge
Secondary button	White, warm hairline border, main text; 32px compact version for row actions ("Mark sent")
Tertiary button	Slate text only, 600 weight
Inputs	40px, white, 8px radius, control border; focus = slate border + 3px slate ring at 18%
Tables	48px rows (40px compact toggle), header `#FBFAF7`, row hover `#F4F1EC`, horizontal dividers only
Badges	Pill, 24px, 12.5px 500 text, 6px dot, status colour on a 12% tint
Icons	Phosphor Regular, 1.5px stroke, 18px in navigation, 16px in UI; KPI icons sit in 36px tinted squares
Illustrations	Small warm line illustrations (slate line, sand fill spots) for empty states, onboarding and milestones; objects and scenes only, no mascot

Navigation

- **Sidebar:** 248px, #F1EEE8, 38px items with 8px rounded active fill. Sections: Home, Applications, Interviews, Follow-ups & tasks, Companies, Contacts, Notes, Insights. A gentle weekly summary card sits at the bottom instead of plan upsells.
- **Top bar:** 64px, transparent on the canvas: search field with a ⌘K hint, "Add application" primary button, notifications bell (sand dot for unread), avatar.
- **Active item:** white fill with a soft shadow, slate icon, deep-slate label; reads like a selected card.
- **Profile:** top-right avatar (#E0E7F0 circle, slate initials) opens settings, theme and sign out.
- **Mobile:** bottom tab bar (Home, Applications, Add, Calendar, More) on white, slate active icon plus label.

Dashboard

The home screen answers "where do I stand and what do I do next" in one scroll; the mockups at the top of this doc show it.

- **Greeting:** Newsreader line with context ("Good afternoon, Asha.") and one supportive sentence.
- **KPI cards (4):** Active applications, Interviews this week, Follow-ups due, Response rate, each with a tinted icon chip and a neutral or positive note; never red for low numbers.
- **Pipeline:** five stage cards (Saved to Offer) with count and a thin bar in the status colour; clicking a stage filters Applications.
- **Coming up:** interviews with date, company logo, round and prep-checklist progress.
- **Follow-ups:** due today and this week with one-click "Mark sent"; overdue shown in warning text.
- **Chart:** applications per week as slate bars with responses as a sand line, last 8 weeks.
- **Recent updates:** status badge plus a plain-language event line.

Application management

- **Table:** company logo (28px rounded square), role in 500, status badge, applied date, next step with due-date chip, salary, source; comfortable rows with a compact toggle; sortable headers, column chooser, bulk select.
- **Board:** columns on ivory with a stage chip and count; white 12px cards show company, role, next step and days in stage. Rejected and Withdrawn columns start collapsed to reduce discouragement.
- **Filters:** pill chips under the page title (Status, Date, Source, Location, Remote); saved views as segmented tabs.
- **Search:** top-bar field plus ⌘K command palette across applications, companies and contacts.
- **Detail page:** hero card (logo, role, company, location, status selector, primary "Log update"), tabs below (Overview, Interviews, Contacts, Notes, Files), right rail with Next steps and Timeline.
- **Activity timeline:** vertical warm hairline, 28px circular icon nodes tinted by event type, friendly copy ("You sent a follow-up to Priya"), newest first, grouped by day.

Forms

- **Inputs and selects:** 40px, label above in 14px 500 secondary text, helper text below in 13px muted with encouraging copy.

- **Selects:** same box with a chevron; long lists become searchable comboboxes, status options show their coloured dot.
- **Date picker:** rounded popover, slate selected day, ivory "today" highlight, quick presets (Today, +3 days, +1 week) for follow-ups.
- **Textareas:** 120px default, auto-grow; used heavily for notes.
- **Checkboxes and radios:** 18px, 5px radius checkbox, slate fill when checked, control-border outline at rest.
- **Validation errors:** error border plus message and icon below the field, phrased helpfully ("Add the company name so we can match it"); a summary banner on submit.
- **Form sections:** each section a white card on ivory with a title and one-line description; long forms become a stepped flow on mobile.

Light and dark mode

Both modes ship; light is the hero and dark is a full-quality peer.

- **Dark canvas:** a neutral slate-charcoal #121519 (not pure black, not blue-black) keeps the calm, warm feel.
- **Primary:** lightens to #93AFD3; primary buttons switch to dark text (#121519, 8.1:1).
- **Elevation:** expressed by lighter surfaces (#1A1F25 → #222830) instead of shadows.
- **Constant across modes:** status hue families, sand accent, layout, typography and the serif greeting.
- **Contrast:** every text token meets 4.5:1 or better on its background in both modes; control borders meet 3:1.

Responsive design

Breakpoint	Layout
Desktop (1280px+)	Full sidebar, 12-column grid, max content width 1360px, comfortable density
Tablet (768–1279px)	Collapsible sidebar, KPI cards 2×2, detail right rail moves under the tabs
Mobile (under 768px)	Bottom tab bar, application list as cards, board as swipeable stages, stepped forms, sticky Save bar; the serif greeting stays

Accessibility

The target is WCAG 2.2 AA; every colour in this doc was checked against its background.

Area	Rule
Colour contrast	Body text 14.6:1, secondary 7.0:1, muted 4.6:1 on ivory; white on slate buttons 7.1:1; status badge text 4.5:1 or better
Focus states	2px slate ring with a 2px ivory offset on every interactive element, including cards and board items
Keyboard	⌘K palette, J/K to move through lists, Enter to open, Esc to close; board cards move via a "Move to…" menu
Error states	Icon plus text, announced to screen readers, never colour alone
Readability	15px body default, 48px table rows, 40px inputs; density toggle for power users

Area	Rule
Touch targets	44×44px minimum on touch devices; compact desktop controls keep at least 24px hit areas
Motion	120–200ms ease-out state changes only; reduced-motion setting respected
Colour-only meaning	Sand never carries meaning alone; every status shows colour plus a label

Design token preview

```
Colors
  brand.primary        #3D5A80 / dark #93AFD3
  brand.primary.hover  #314967 / dark #A9C1E0
  brand.secondary      #25384F / dark #E0E7F0
  brand.accent         #D9A574 / dark #E2B48A   (text variant #8A5A2B)
  bg.canvas #F8F6F2 · bg.sidebar #F1EEE8 · bg.surface #FFFFFF · bg.elevated #FFFEFC
  dark: bg.canvas #121519 · bg.sidebar #15191E · bg.surface #1A1F25 · bg.elevated #222830
  text.primary #1E2329 · text.secondary #4D5560 · text.muted #69707A
  border.hairline #E8E3DA · border.control #8E949C
  feedback.success #2E7D4F · warning #9E5C06 · error #C42B3A · info #1C6FAE
  status.saved #646B78 · applied #1C6FAE · screening #0F7A73 · interviewing #6B4FB8
         offer #2E7D4F · rejected #A0524A · withdrawn #69707A
Typography
  family.sans Figtree · family.display Newsreader (limited)
  size 12 / 13 / 14 / 15 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32 · weight 400 / 500 / 600
Spacing
  4px base: 4 8 12 16 20 24 32 40 48 64
  card padding 24 · row height 48 (compact 40) · section gap 32
Radius
  sm 8 · md 12 · lg 16 · pill 999
Shadows
  card     0 1 3 rgba(60,45,30,0.06)
  overlay  0 12 32 rgba(60,45,30,0.12)
  button   0 1 2 rgba(37,56,79,0.22) + inset 0 -1 0 rgba(0,0,0,0.16)
Borders
  1px border.hairline · controls 1px border.control · focus 2px brand.primary + 2px offset
```

Next step: confirm this direction and it becomes the final UI/visual design system, with full component specs, states and screen patterns.